

Don't Pre-Plan

Finally the one phone that is supposed to beat the iPhone or atleast be the closest to defeating the iPhone is here – Palm Pre. Too bad it hasn't launched in India yet, wonder when that day will come...

They live!

Alienware is soon to launch their M17x gaming laptop in India. Base specs include C2D 8600, 64-bit Windows Vista and an Nvidia GTX260M as a graphics solution. The price of this mean machine will start at around Rs. 86,000 but it will definitely go higher.

Bazaar



Hitachi Travelstars

A tiny difference

Notebook hard drives are the 2.5-inch versions of 3.5-inch drives. We received two 2.5-inch notebook hard drives from Hitachi – the Travelstar 5K500 HTS545050KTA300 and the Travelstar 5K500.B HTS545050B9A300. Both have a capacity of 500 GB and an 8 MB cache.

The 5K500 measures 12.5 mm whereas the 5K500.B has a height of 9.5 mm. Both these drives have SATA interfaces with the only difference here being that the 5K500 does not have a cover

over the SATA connectors while the 5K500.B does have it. The 5K500 drive is based on a three-platter design, whereas the 5K500.B drive has a two-platter design.

We tested these drives with Windows Vista, an Intel Core 2 Duo E6700 processor @ 2.66 GHz and 2 GB of DDR 2 memory. The benchmarks for these drives include HD Tach RW, SiSoft Sandra 2009. SP2, 4 GB file transfer tests and a 1-GB Photoshop scratch disk test.

In these benchmarks, the 5K500 showed better overall performance in read and

write tests in comparison to the 5K500.B. The CPU utilisation of the 5K500 drive is less. The only place where the 5K500.B shines is the burst speed – 246.5 MBps in comparison to 184.6 MBps. The higher the burst speed, the faster you will be able to open up files and applications.

When it comes to real world tests, the 5K500.B outperforms the 5K500 by quite a margin. With our real world file transfer tests, we found the average read and write speeds of the 5K500 drive to be 41.92 MBps and 58.23 MBps, respectively. In comparison, the 5K500.B gave us average read and write speeds of 58.17 MBps and 61.98 MBps, respectively. These scores clearly show why the 5K500.

Contact

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Price for 5K500: Rs. 7,800

Price for 5K500.B: Rs. 7,500

5K500/500.B

Specifications

Interface: SATA 3 Gb/s, Capacity:

500 GB

Data disks: 3/2

Data heads (physical): 6/4

Data Buffer: 8 MB

Dimensions (H x W x D):

12.5 x 70 x 100 mm/9.5 x 70 x

100 mm

Weight: 148 grams

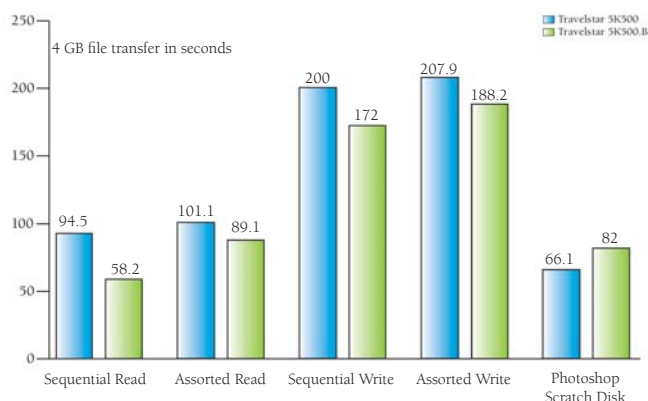
RATINGS 5K500/500.B

Features	8/8
Performance	7/8
Build Quality	7.5/8
Value for money	7/7.5
Overall	7/7.5

B is the superior drive.

Both these drives kept silent and neither of them got too warm. When it comes down to pure performance, it would be better to get the Hitachi 5K500.B rather than the 5K500.

The 5K500.B is priced at Rs. 7,500, whereas the 5K500 is priced at Rs. 7,800. The prices of both the drives are on the higher side, and if you intend to go for a notebook hard drive, then we suggest you get the Seagate Momentus 5400.6 as it is great value for money.



	Travelstar 5K500	Travelstar 5K500.B
HD Tach (32 MB Zone)		
Random Access Time	18.2 ms	18.1 ms
CPU Utilization	3 %	4 %
Average Read	54.8 MB/s	67.7 MB/s
Average Write	52.8 MB/s	65 MB/s
Burst Speed	184.6 MB/s	246.5 MB/s